

STILL HELD

Psalms for Every Stage of Grief

(Coloring & Reflection Journal)

[ILLUSTRATION: hands holding a broken heart
with golden light filling the cracks]

Volume 2

Daniel Tesfamariam

KJV Scripture

STILL HELD

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Dedicated to those walking through the valley.

You are still held.

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HOW TO USE THIS JOURNAL

Grief is not a straight line. It comes in waves, circles, and spirals. This journal is organized by the stages of grief, but you do NOT have to go in order.

Open to the stage that matches where you are TODAY.

EACH PSALM INCLUDES:

- * A coloring page with the verse in a decorative frame
- * A reflection page with guided prompts

THE FIVE STAGES:

1. Shock & Denial - When it doesn't feel real
2. Anger - When you're mad at God, life, everyone
3. Bargaining - When you ask 'what if' and 'if only'
4. Depression - When the weight feels unbearable
5. Acceptance - When hope begins to return

REMEMBER:

- * There is no timeline for grief
- * All emotions are valid before God
- * You may revisit stages many times
- * Coloring can calm your nervous system
- * God can handle your honest prayers

STAGE 1: SHOCK & DENIAL

The world has stopped making sense. Everything feels surreal.

7 Psalms for this season

[ILLUSTRATION: thorny branch becoming blooming roses]

[ILLUSTRATION: thorny branch becoming blooming roses]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 77:1-2

**I cried unto God with my voice; my soul refused
to be comforted.**

[ILLUSTRATION: broken vessel with light streaming through cracks]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 77:1-2

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: storm clouds parting to reveal sun]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 13:1

How long wilt thou forget me, O Lord? for ever?

[ILLUSTRATION: winter landscape with first spring flower]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 13:1

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: withered tree with one green branch]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 88:1-2

**O Lord God of my salvation, I have cried day and
night before thee.**

[ILLUSTRATION: hands releasing a dove into sky]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 88:1-2

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: broken vessel with light streaming through cracks]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 102:1-2

**Hear my prayer, O Lord, and let my cry come unto
thee.**

[ILLUSTRATION: seed in dark soil with roots growing]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 102:1-2

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: winter landscape with first spring flower]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 6:6

**I am weary with my groaning; all the night make
I my bed to swim.**

[ILLUSTRATION: bridge over troubled waters]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 6:6

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: hands releasing a dove into sky]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 77:7-9

**Will the Lord cast off for ever? and will he be
favourable no more?**

[ILLUSTRATION: candle flame in darkness]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 77:7-9

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: seed in dark soil with roots growing]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 143:4

**Therefore is my spirit overwhelmed within me; my
heart is desolate.**

[ILLUSTRATION: rainbow after storm over valley]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 143:4

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

STAGE 2: ANGER

The pain turns to fury. Why? How could God allow this?

7 Psalms for this season

[ILLUSTRATION: bridge over troubled waters]

[ILLUSTRATION: bridge over troubled waters]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 10:1

**Why standest thou afar off, O Lord? why hidest
thou thyself in times of trouble?**

[ILLUSTRATION: thorny branch becoming blooming roses]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 10:1

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: candle flame in darkness]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 22:1-2

**My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? why
art thou so far from helping me?**

[ILLUSTRATION: storm clouds parting to reveal sun]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 22:1-2

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: rainbow after storm over valley]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 74:1

O God, why hast thou cast us off for ever?

[ILLUSTRATION: withered tree with one green branch]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 74:1

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: thorny branch becoming blooming roses]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 44:23-24

**Awake, why sleepest thou, O Lord? Wherefore
hidest thou thy face?**

[ILLUSTRATION: broken vessel with light streaming through cracks]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 44:23-24

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: storm clouds parting to reveal sun]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 39:10

**Remove thy stroke away from me: I am consumed by
the blow of thine hand.**

[ILLUSTRATION: winter landscape with first spring flower]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 39:10

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: withered tree with one green branch]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 88:14

**Lord, why castest thou off my soul? why hidest
thou thy face from me?**

[ILLUSTRATION: hands releasing a dove into sky]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 88:14

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: broken vessel with light streaming through cracks]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 109:21-22

**Do thou for me, for thy name's sake. For I am
poor and needy, and my heart is wounded.**

[ILLUSTRATION: seed in dark soil with roots growing]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 109:21-22

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

STAGE 3: BARGAINING

If only... What if... The mind searches for answers.

5 Psalms for this season

[ILLUSTRATION: winter landscape with first spring flower]

[ILLUSTRATION: winter landscape with first spring flower]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 51:10-12

**Create in me a clean heart, O God; and renew a
right spirit within me.**

[ILLUSTRATION: bridge over troubled waters]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 51:10-12

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: hands releasing a dove into sky]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 25:4-5

Shew me thy ways, O Lord; teach me thy paths.

[ILLUSTRATION: candle flame in darkness]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 25:4-5

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: seed in dark soil with roots growing]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 90:12

**So teach us to number our days, that we may
apply our hearts unto wisdom.**

[ILLUSTRATION: rainbow after storm over valley]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 90:12

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: bridge over troubled waters]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 119:71

**It is good for me that I have been afflicted;
that I might learn thy statutes.**

[ILLUSTRATION: thorny branch becoming blooming roses]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 119:71

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: candle flame in darkness]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 27:7-8

**Hear, O Lord, when I cry with my voice: have
mercy upon me.**

[ILLUSTRATION: storm clouds parting to reveal sun]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 27:7-8

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

STAGE 4: DEPRESSION

The full weight of loss settles in. Darkness feels permanent.

6 Psalms for this season

[ILLUSTRATION: rainbow after storm over valley]

[ILLUSTRATION: rainbow after storm over valley]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 6:2-3

**Have mercy upon me, O Lord; for I am weak. My
soul is also sore vexed.**

[ILLUSTRATION: withered tree with one green branch]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 6:2-3

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: thorny branch becoming blooming roses]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 38:6-8

**I am troubled; I am bowed down greatly; I go
mourning all the day long.**

[ILLUSTRATION: broken vessel with light streaming through cracks]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 38:6-8

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: storm clouds parting to reveal sun]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 42:3

My tears have been my meat day and night.

[ILLUSTRATION: winter landscape with first spring flower]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 42:3

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: withered tree with one green branch]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 69:1-2

**Save me, O God; for the waters are come in unto
my soul. I sink in deep mire.**

[ILLUSTRATION: hands releasing a dove into sky]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 69:1-2

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: broken vessel with light streaming through cracks]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 88:6

**Thou hast laid me in the lowest pit, in
darkness, in the deeps.**

[ILLUSTRATION: seed in dark soil with roots growing]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 88:6

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: winter landscape with first spring flower]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 143:7

Hear me speedily, O Lord: my spirit faileth.

Hide not thy face from me.

[ILLUSTRATION: bridge over troubled waters]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 143:7

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

STAGE 5: ACCEPTANCE & HOPE

Slowly, breath by breath, hope whispers again.

5 Psalms for this season

[ILLUSTRATION: hands releasing a dove into sky]

[ILLUSTRATION: hands releasing a dove into sky]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 30:11-12

**Thou hast turned for me my mourning into
dancing.**

[ILLUSTRATION: candle flame in darkness]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 30:11-12

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: seed in dark soil with roots growing]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 40:1-3

**I waited patiently for the Lord; and he inclined
unto me. He put a new song in my mouth.**

[ILLUSTRATION: rainbow after storm over valley]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 40:1-3

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: bridge over troubled waters]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 116:1-2

**I love the Lord, because he hath heard my voice
and my supplications.**

[ILLUSTRATION: thorny branch becoming blooming roses]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 116:1-2

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: candle flame in darkness]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 126:5-6

They that sow in tears shall reap in joy.

[ILLUSTRATION: storm clouds parting to reveal sun]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 126:5-6

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

[ILLUSTRATION: rainbow after storm over valley]

Color this image as a prayer of lament

Psalm 23:6

**Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me all
the days of my life.**

[ILLUSTRATION: withered tree with one green branch]

Color this page as a prayer

Reflecting on Psalm 23:6

What grief stage am I in today?

How does this Psalm match my feelings?

What would I say to God right now?

One thing I need Him to know:

My honest prayer:

MY GRIEF TIMELINE

Date of loss: _____

Person/thing I'm grieving: _____

Month 1:

Month 3:

Month 6:

Month 9:

Month 12:

Month 18:

Year 2+:

GRIEF SUPPORT RESOURCES

GriefShare - griefshare.org

988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline - Call or text 988

Crisis Text Line - Text HOME to 741741

National Alliance on Mental Illness - nami.org

Your local church pastoral care team

Remember: Seeking help is an act of faith, not weakness.

CERTIFICATE OF COURAGE

This certifies that

(your name)

has walked through the valley of grief
with courage, faith, and the Psalms.

You are STILL HELD.

"The Lord is nigh unto them that are of a
broken heart." - Psalm 34:18

Date: _____